

inclusion, including new age technologies like machine learning, augmented reality and virtual reality.

'Indian Open Source Project Incubator' will also encourage students to contribute to open source projects. Paytm plans to conduct hackathons, bootcamps, meet-ups, and monitoring sessions while partnering with around 20 institutions. Outstanding external contributors to the open source project will be awarded 'Paytm Scholar' certificates as well as the opportunity to join the company.

'World in Conflict' servers' code gets open sourced

In a major move, Ubisoft has released an open source version of Massgate, the central server that once powered the online functionality for Massive Entertainment's real-time strategy title, World in Conflict.

With open source code nestled snugly in a GitHub repository, players can now host their own World in Conflict servers. And, as Ubisoft points out, the code itself offers an educational snapshot of how online servers were crafted over a decade ago.



The company says it was inspired to open Massgate up to the public after watching community-led efforts to bring the game's multi-player functions back to life. According to Ubisoft, the code is, more or less, the same as

it was when the game was launched in 2007, save for a few tweaks made to make it compatible with modern compilers.

World in Conflict marks the second notable game to have missing features restored recently through the release of open source code. Riot-owned Radiant Entertainment also recently announced that it would be releasing a build of its cancelled fighting game Rising Thunder, complete with an open source version of the source code for its online servers.

LinkedIn open sources tools to combat website navigation issues

Lead developer Steven Callister in a blog post shared that LinkedIn has open sourced two new tools to assist engineers in automating the investigation of broken hosts and services: Fossor and Ascii Etch. Fossor (the Latin word for grave digger) is a Python tool, while Ascii Etch, another Python library, outputs information gleaned from Fossor in Ascii-character graphs.

Callister wrote in a blog post, "Having experienced the pain of performing the same repetitive steps again and again during my own on-call shifts, I concluded that writing a tool to perform some of these basic checks in parallel would speed up the mean time to resolution. Taking the idea even further, I wanted a tool that could



perform checks tailored specifically to my services while still having the flexibility to incorporate newly-developed checks in the future. Fossor was created to do just that."

Fossor's design splits the two components of the program, the engine and plugins, to reduce the incidence of serious bugs, whereas Ascii Etch was originally created to draw the results from running Fossor. Callister wrote that it proved more helpful than simple text for quickly spotting anomalies in the data.

Callister also said that the development team hopes that the specificity-through-modularity of Fossor will greatly benefit site administrators and the open source community while it contributes more plugins to the automation tool. Now that Ascii Etch is open sourced, it also supports vertical value scaling, as well as horizontal value compression.

Amazon's cloud business takes a leap with Linux 2

Amazon has started offering its enterprise customers a new version of the Linux operating system -- Linux 2, which runs from Amazon's data centres. Thus, it replaces the cloud computing juggernaut's software that needs to be installed on customers' own servers.



While Amazon is making the software available for companies to install on their own servers, it is also renting access to Linux 2 to its cloud customers. There, it can be used to run many of the most popular server software programs and technologies, including Microsoft's Hyper-V, VMware, Oracle's VM VirtualBox, Docker and Amazon's Docker alternative, Amazon Machine Image.

Linux 2 carries five years' support that promises security patches and bug fixes, just like other software vendors offer with their wares. Needless to mention, it is designed to work well with open source databases, programming languages and other popular applications.

The move is significant, because now Amazon competes with companies that provide server hardware and software. With Linux 2, instead of buying it, enterprises can now rent it all from the cloud and pay fees on a per-use basis. Linux 2 is the second version of Linux Amazon. Customers could run the previous version on their own servers also, but in a much more limited way.